

WORKSHOP SERIES 03 · FINAL SESSION

CodeArena'26

From Ideas to Shipped Products in 36 Hours

IET On Campus KDU, in collaboration with IET Young Professionals Network Sri Lanka

Shalani Avodya Anudini - Senior Data Analyst, Group Analytics & AI, Dialog Axiata

5 September 2026 · 7.00 PM onwards · Zoom



Briefing Overview

01 The Competition

What CodeArena'26 is · Why take part · How the 36 hours run · Key dates

02 Building Your Solution

System anatomy · A worked example · How to structure your pitch

03 Rules & Judgement

Guidelines · Judging criteria · Selection and the Grand Finale

01

The Competition

What you are entering, and when everything happens.



CodeArena'26: Build. Demonstrate. Deliver

You have 36 continuous hours to turn a topic into a working prototype.

ORGANISER	IET On Campus	General Sir John Kotelawala Defence University
FORMAT	36-hour team sprint	One continuous build window, followed by a live pitch
ELIGIBILITY	Undergraduate students	Any undergraduate student
DELIVERABLE	A working prototype	Turn your skills into a working solution that runs, performs, and delivers
SUPPORT	Industry mentors	Available throughout the build window

Four checkpoints between registering and pitching

01

Form your team

3–5 members. Register before 10 September

02

Select your topic

The industry mentors releases a set of topics on 11 September. Your team selects one and commits to it together.

03

Build for 36 hours

11–13 September. One continuous window - all work happens here

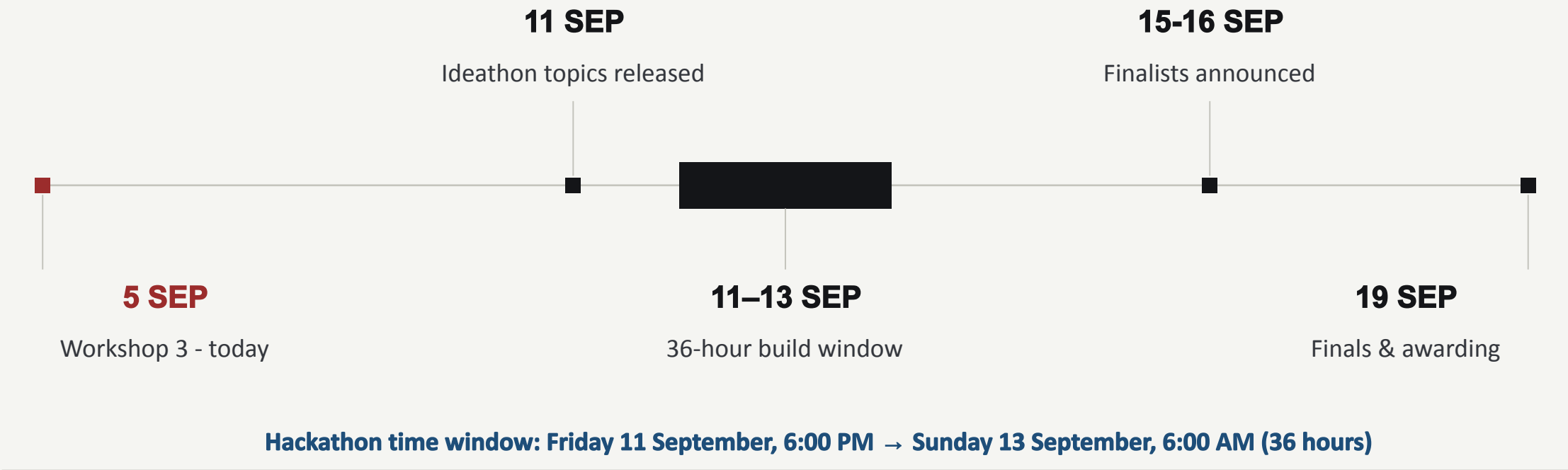
04

Submit and pitch

Submit your code and a PPT walkthrough of the build start to end, with screenshots via the link provided.

Team size, submission format and permitted tools are set by the organising committee - confirm before you register.

Topics drop 11 September - have a team before then



02

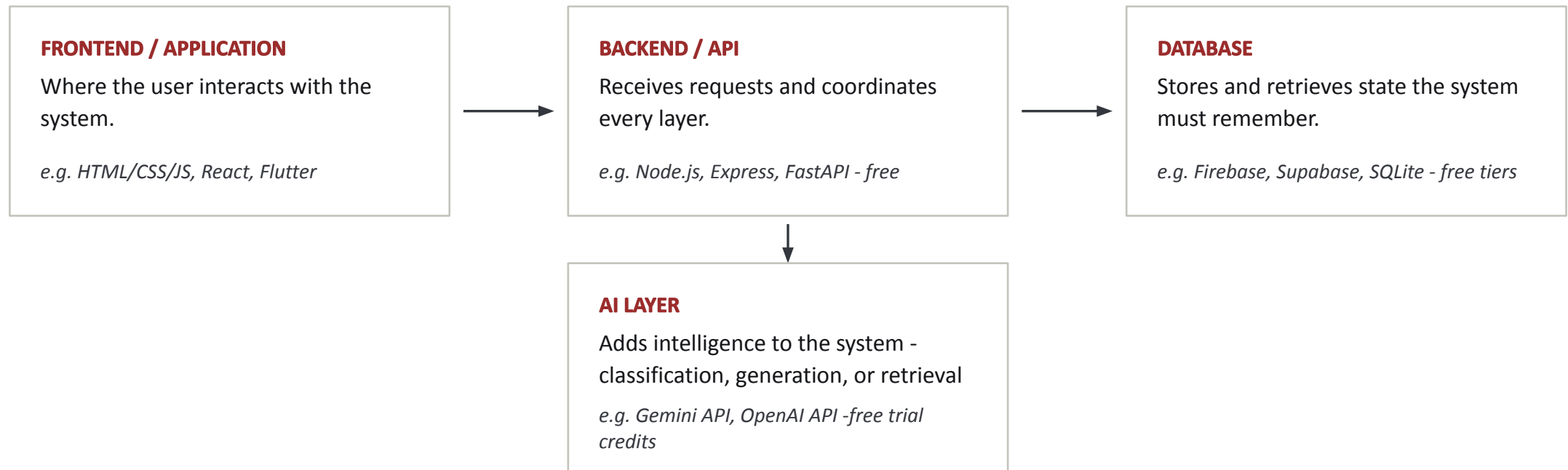
Building Your Solution

What a working prototype looks like, and how to present it.



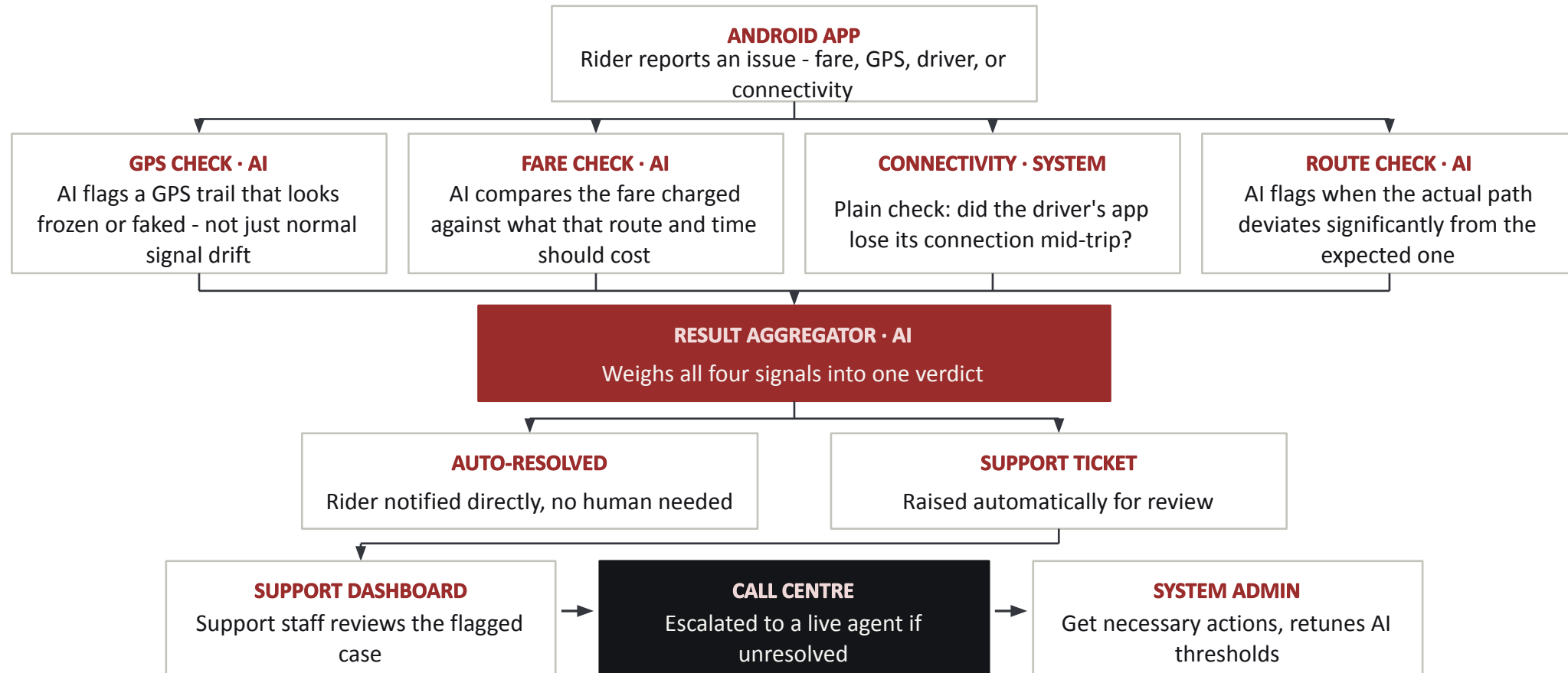
Every solution needs the same four layers

Regardless of your topic, your prototype has to demonstrate this structure working end to end.



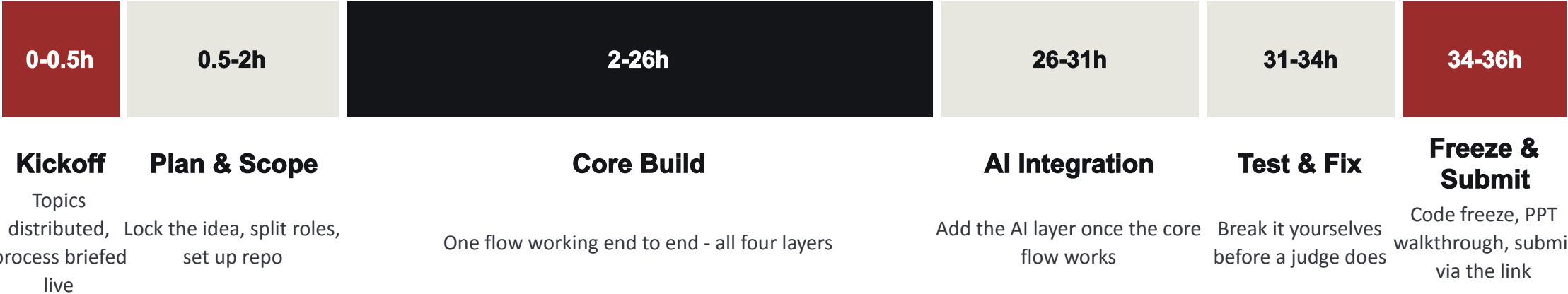
Example: Diagnosing and escalating a ride app issue

Illustrative example only - the real topics are released on 11 September.



Plan your 36 hours before you start building

A proposed breakdown - adapt it, but don't skip the planning block.



Core Build is the biggest block on purpose. Teams that skip Plan & Scope usually lose more than 30 minutes finding it again at hour 10.

Structure your final pitch

01

Why

The problem, who it affects, and what is wrong with how it is handled today.

02

What

The system you built. Scope, boundaries, and what it does not attempt.

03

How

Architecture and method. The flow, the components, and the key decisions you made.

04

Proof

Evidence it works. A live run, test cases, or measurements - not assertions.

05

Judgement

What was achieved, what was not, and the limitations you know about.

Most teams over-spend on Why and run out of time before Proof. Rehearse with a timer and cut the introduction first.

Build Something to Take Beyond CodeArena'26.

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- | | | |
|-----------|--------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | A portfolio-ready deliverable | A functioning system, and the ability to explain every choice behind it - the most valuable thing you can walk away from a hackathon with. |
| <hr/> | | |
| 02 | Mentorship while you build | Industry mentors are available during the window. |
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| 03 | A live technical audience | Finalists present at the Dialog Auditorium in front of judges from industry - real defence practice. |
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| 04 | Recognition | Certificates and prizes for top teams at the Grand Finale (details to be confirmed by the committee). |
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03

Rules & Judgement

What is required of you, and how you will be assessed.



Build inside the window, and own every line of it

ELIGIBILITY & TEAMS

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- 01** Open to undergraduate students.
 - 02** Teams of 3–5 members
 - 03** One entry per team. Register before 10 September.
 - 04** All implementation work must happen inside the 36-hour window.
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CONDUCT & SUBMISSION

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- 01** No pre-built submissions. Existing libraries and frameworks are fine; a finished project is not.
 - 02** Be ready to explain any part of your code on request.
 - 03** Submit the repository link and pitch materials before the stated deadline.
 - 04** Late submissions are not assessed. Breaches of the code of conduct mean disqualification.
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Final rules are issued by the organising committee - these are the working guidelines for this briefing.

Every criterion needs evidence, not assertion

	CRITERION	WHAT WE ASK	EVIDENCE WE LOOK FOR
01	Technical execution	Does it run end to end, live, in front of us?	A working demonstration
02	Problem fit	Does it address a real, well-defined problem?	A clear problem statement
03	User experience	Is it usable and coherent to someone new?	A walkthrough by a judge
04	Presentation	Can the team explain the build in the time given?	A structured, timed pitch
05	Impact & feasibility	Would this hold up beyond the ideathon?	Stated limits and next steps

Finalists pitch live at the Dialog Auditorium

TOP 10 TEAMS

Advance from the 36-hour build to the Grand Finale.

ANNOUNCED

16 September 2026

Finalist teams published by the committee

FINALE

19 September 2026

Per the current schedule- to be confirmed

VENUE

Dialog Auditorium

Off campus, in front of an industry panel

FORMAT

Live pitch + awards

Timed presentation, questions, then the awarding ceremony

Don't just solve it -Reimagine it

The obvious idea is already taken...
Build the one nobody expected 😊

